

Buying cinema tickets

One fine day, the boss woke up and ordered: Let's go for a movie to celebrate the magazine's third anniversary. I was given the responsibility of buying tickets for Lakshya for the entire team. I had two choices before me: to book online or to make the trip to the theatre, and stand in queue. I decided to rough it out both ways. Here's the result:

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Buying tickets over the counter



Buying tickets online

Photograph: Jiten Gandhi

1

From Nerul, in Navi Mumbai where our office is located, I took the train to Wadala, a central Mumbai suburb and the station closest to the theatre—Imax Adlabs. I then cabbed it to Imax.

Time taken 40 minutes for the train journey, **25 minutes** for the taxi ride

Visited the Imax Adlabs Web site, and registered for their services.

Time taken 3 minutes

2

It was a weekday, so the crowd didn't resemble a Rajnikant opener down south, where I come from. If it were a weekend, I would have perhaps felt at home. More luck—tickets were available. Imagine travelling 65 minutes to find out that there are no tickets!

Time taken to check availability 2 minutes

Selected the movie, date and time of our choice—surprisingly, I could also choose the seats. Remember the old days, when a grumpy old man behind the ticket window would decide where you sat? Slipping him a tenner would get you a better seat though!

Time taken 5 minutes

3

Stood in queue to buy 11 tickets (priced at Rs 130 each). There were just about 15 people in front of me, yet each person took an aeon to decide which seat he or she wanted. So I twiddled my thumbs for possibly the longest I have ever done, since my last exams.

Time taken in queue 25 minutes

Then, I had to select a mode of payment. I settled for a credit card transaction. The site threw up a transaction ID, along with the order details.

Time taken 8 minutes

(I also spent **5 minutes** presenting my Transaction ID at Imax and collecting my tickets)

4

Total cost **Rs 1,521**: **Rs 1,430** for the movie tickets, **Rs 21** (return train ticket—second class), **Rs 70** (taxi fare—to and from the theatre)

My condition: Exhausted! Oh, and I still have to travel for a little over an hour to get back to the office.

Total cost **Rs 1,430** (This only applies to credit card transactions; booking over the phone costs **Rs 10** extra per ticket for home delivery)

My condition Happy! And, I never had to leave the comfort of my chair at office

Total time taken **2 hour 37 minutes**
Total cost **Rs 1,521**



Total time taken **21 minutes**
Total cost **Rs 1,430**



AND
THE
WINNER
IS...

Tech Way, it's cheaper! Besides, I figured it's not cool to travel by train for so long, then cab it even longer, and then stand in queue twiddling thumbs. Instead just buy the tickets online, over the phone, or

even via SMS. On the other hand, if I had hours to kill, and masti-seeking company, I might just decide to make the trip to Wadala, for an evening of movie magic—ticket counter mayhem included.